

Business

1. J.B. Hunt, one of America's largest trucking and logistics companies, recently warned investors that its third-quarter earnings would fall by between 5% and 10%. How did its stock price react on the day of the announcement?
 - a. It dropped around 5%, roughly matching the earnings warning
 - b. It dropped around 13%, far more than the earnings shortfall
 - c. It actually rose 3%, as investors had expected worse
2. easyJet cabin crew in Portugal have recently voted to strike during two very specific windows this autumn and winter. Which dates did they choose, and why do those dates matter so much to the airline?
 - a. October 2–6 and December 19–23, covering a school half-term and Christmas travel peak
 - b. November 1–5 and January 2–6, targeting post-holiday lulls to maximise union leverage
 - c. September 28–30 and December 31–January 1, focusing purely on New Year's Eve flights
3. Warren Buffett recently stepped down as chair of Berkshire Hathaway after more than six decades leading the company, handing over the role to a family member. Who took over as chair of the roughly \$1 trillion conglomerate?
 - a. His son Howard Buffett
 - b. His longtime business partner Charlie Munger's son
 - c. Greg Abel, already named as CEO successor
4. Swiss running-shoe brand On — known for its cloud-shaped soles and Silicon Valley fanbase — just signed its first-ever football (soccer) player endorsement deal. Which global superstar switched from Nike to On?
 - a. Erling Haaland, fresh off a Champions League final
 - b. Kylian Mbappé, ending a roughly two-decade partnership with Nike
 - c. Jude Bellingham, looking to distinguish himself from Adidas teammates

Economics

5. The Bank of England recently held its main interest rate at 3.75%, but UK inflation (the rate at which prices across the economy are rising) climbed to a five-month high. What figure did inflation reach, and what was the main driver pushing it up?
 - a. 3.1%, driven largely by energy price shocks
 - b. 2.6%, driven by rising food costs at supermarkets
 - c. 4.0%, driven by a sharp jump in housing rents

6. The US Federal Reserve (America's central bank) recently raised its benchmark interest rate (the rate it charges banks to borrow, which flows through to mortgages and loans) for the first time since July 2023, pushing it to a range of 3.75%–4%. What made this decision especially notable?
 - a. It was a split vote, with three governors dissenting in favour of a cut
 - b. It was unanimous, and came despite direct pressure from President Trump to cut rates
 - c. It was the largest single rate rise since 1994, catching markets off guard
7. Donald Trump recently threatened the EU with 'serious tariffs' (taxes on imported goods) and a possible halt to trade altogether. What triggered the threat?
 - a. The EU proposed making Canada its first-ever associate member, which Trump called 'laughable'
 - b. The EU announced new digital services taxes targeting American tech companies
 - c. The EU blocked a major US agricultural export deal over food safety standards
8. Despite widespread worry about cost-of-living pressures, the US Census Bureau recently published data showing median household income (the income of the typical American family, right in the middle of the distribution) hit a record high in 2025. How much was it?
 - a. Around \$74,000
 - b. Around \$81,000
 - c. Around \$87,000

General Knowledge

9. Which country is the world's largest producer of lithium, the metal that sits at the heart of electric vehicle batteries and is reshaping global energy geopolitics?
 - a. Chile
 - b. Australia
 - c. China
10. One of history's most influential economists wrote 'The Wealth of Nations' in 1776 — the same year as the American Declaration of Independence — and is widely credited with founding the modern discipline of economics. Who was he?
 - a. David Ricardo
 - b. Adam Smith
 - c. John Stuart Mill

Business

1. J.B. Hunt, one of America's largest trucking and logistics companies, recently warned investors that its third-quarter earnings would fall by between 5% and 10%. How did its stock price react on the day of the announcement?

b. J.B. Hunt's stock fell 13% — more than double the size of the earnings warning itself. This is a classic market overreaction: investors don't just price in bad news, they price in uncertainty about what comes next. For a freight company, a profit warning also signals broader worry about the health of the whole economy, since goods have to move before they can be sold.

2. easyJet cabin crew in Portugal have recently voted to strike during two very specific windows this autumn and winter. Which dates did they choose, and why do those dates matter so much to the airline?

a. The strikes target October 2–6 and December 19–23 — a school half-term break and the final days before Christmas. Timing is everything in industrial action: walking out when planes are fullest maximises disruption and passenger pressure on the airline to settle. For easyJet, which relies heavily on leisure travellers, a Christmas strike is about as costly as it gets.

3. Warren Buffett recently stepped down as chair of Berkshire Hathaway after more than six decades leading the company, handing over the role to a family member. Who took over as chair of the roughly \$1 trillion conglomerate?

a. Howard Buffett, Warren's son, has taken over as non-executive chair. The chair and CEO roles are being split: Greg Abel becomes CEO, handling day-to-day operations, while Howard provides oversight. Warren Buffett first took control of Berkshire in 1965, when it was a failing textile mill worth a few million dollars. It is now one of the largest companies on earth.

4. Swiss running-shoe brand On — known for its cloud-shaped soles and Silicon Valley fanbase — just signed its first-ever football (soccer) player endorsement deal. Which global superstar switched from Nike to On?

b. Mbappé has signed with On, walking away from a Nike deal that dated back to his early teens. For On — a brand that until recently was mostly associated with recreational joggers and tech-bro athleisure — landing one of football's biggest names is a serious statement of ambition. Nike, meanwhile, loses its most recognisable active footballer just as it's trying to claw back market share from Adidas and New Balance.

Economics

5. The Bank of England recently held its main interest rate at 3.75%, but UK inflation (the rate at which prices across the economy are rising) climbed to a five-month high. What figure did inflation reach, and what was the main driver pushing it up?

a. UK inflation hit 3.1%, a five-month high, with energy prices doing most of the damage. The vote to hold rates was not unanimous — three of the nine Monetary Policy Committee members wanted to raise rates immediately, reflecting genuine disagreement about whether holding is the right call. The Bank's official target is 2%, so at 3.1%, inflation is still meaningfully above where policymakers want it.

6. The US Federal Reserve (America's central bank) recently raised its benchmark interest rate (the rate it charges banks to borrow, which flows through to mortgages and loans) for the first time since July 2023, pushing it to a range of 3.75%–4%. What made this decision especially notable?

b. The Fed voted unanimously to raise rates — and did so in direct defiance of public pressure from President Trump, who has repeatedly called for cuts. Central bank independence (the principle that rate decisions should be made by technocrats, not politicians) is a cornerstone of modern monetary policy, and this vote was a pointed demonstration of it. The last hike before this one was in July 2023.

7. Donald Trump recently threatened the EU with 'serious tariffs' (taxes on imported goods) and a possible halt to trade altogether. What triggered the threat?

a. Trump's threat came after the EU floated the idea of offering Canada associate membership — a novel status that would deepen transatlantic ties and, in Trump's reading, gang up on the US. The EU-US trade relationship is one of the world's largest, worth over \$1 trillion a year in goods and services, so even the threat of serious tariffs has real economic weight on both sides of the Atlantic.

8. Despite widespread worry about cost-of-living pressures, the US Census Bureau recently published data showing median household income (the income of the typical American family, right in the middle of the distribution) hit a record high in 2025. How much was it?

c. Median household income reached \$87,460 — a record high and higher than most people would guess given how loudly economic anxiety has dominated the news. The median figure matters more than the average because it isn't skewed by billionaires at the top. That said, record income doesn't mean everyone feels comfortable: if prices have risen faster than wages in recent years, households can earn more in dollar terms and still feel squeezed.

General Knowledge

9. Which country is the world's largest producer of lithium, the metal that sits at the heart of electric vehicle batteries and is reshaping global energy geopolitics?

b. Australia is the world's largest lithium producer by volume, accounting for roughly half of global mine output. Chile holds the largest known reserves, concentrated in the Atacama salt flats, and is second in production. China dominates the refining and processing stage — meaning it turns raw lithium into the battery-grade material manufacturers actually need, giving it enormous leverage in the EV supply chain.

10. One of history's most influential economists wrote 'The Wealth of Nations' in 1776 — the same year as the American Declaration of Independence — and is widely credited with founding the modern discipline of economics. Who was he?

b. Adam Smith, a Scottish philosopher, published 'The Wealth of Nations' in 1776, introducing ideas like the division of labour and the 'invisible hand' — the notion that individuals pursuing self-interest can inadvertently benefit society as a whole. Ricardo came later and developed trade theory; Mill was a later Victorian philosopher-economist. Smith's face appeared on the UK £20 note from 2007 to 2021.